Mandatory Reporting Quick Reference Guide

Virtual Educator Compliance | Colorado Revised Statutes § 19-3-304

1. IMMEDIATE ACTION PROTOCOL (STEP-BY-STEP)

1 OBSERVE
Identify visual indicators, written disclosures, or credible digital evidence.

2 PRESERVE
Save exact timestamps, screenshots, and objective digital LMS logs.

3 REPORT
Immediately notify County DHS or Law Enforcement. Do not wait.

4 NOTIFY
Inform designated school leadership internally after filing the report.

2. REASONABLE SUSPICION

Indicator Category	Virtual Context Examples
Direct Observations	Seeing physical injuries (such as unexplained burns, bruises, fractures, or welts), severe malnourishment, unsafe living conditions, or sudden concerning behavior shifts while interacting with the student online.
Circumstances or Conditions	Observing a child subjected to an environment or situation that would reasonably result in abuse or neglect.
Direct Disclosures	A child, parent, or other person telling the mandatory reporter about abuse or neglect.

⚠ Critical Legal Rule: Imminent Harm & Caregiver Contact

NEVER contact parents or guardians prior to notifying DHS or Law Enforcement when physical harm or abuse is suspected. Alerting caregivers prior to an official investigation places the student at severe risk of immediate retaliation or escalation.

LEGAL BOUNDARIES FOR VIRTUAL EDUCATORS

DO (Mandatory Actions)

- **Report Immediately:** File a report as soon as reasonable suspicion is established.
- **Log Objective Facts:** Record exact dates, times, quotes, and screen captures.
- **Act Individually:** You own the legal duty; do not wait for supervisor approval.
- **Accept Digital Evidence:** Screenshots and chat logs constitute valid suspicion.

DON'T (Prohibited Actions)

- **Do NOT Investigate:** Never interview the student or demand physical proof.
- **Do NOT Promise Secrecy:** You cannot honor student privacy requests regarding abuse.
- **Do NOT Contact Caregivers:** Never alert family before contacting DHS.
- **Do NOT Delegate:** Leaving a voicemail for leadership does not fulfill your duty.

3. REPORTING CONTACT DIRECTORY & RESOURCES

Agency	Contact Channel	Availability
Colorado Child Abuse Hotline	**1-844-CO-4-KIDS (1-844-264-5437)**	24 / 7 / 365 Toll-Free
Local Law Enforcement	Dial 911 (Emergency) or Local Dispatch	Immediate Response